

Transitioning to the next level

In the next decade, personal transportation will be complemented by a whole new approach to getting from 'A' to 'B.' The compressed air-powered car from Tata Group and other short trip vehicular variants will dominate the world market for urban mobility as an adjunct to built-in architectural features such as escalators, moving walkways and large lift platform areas. In my latest collection, *Sentury II* I've included several pictures of the Hypervan, a luxury, high-speed intercity transporter that represents the persistence of private transport. New materials and miniaturized electronics will furnish even bottom market vehicles with state-of-the-art personal media devices and electronic links to the vehicle's operation. There'll be a proliferation of various wearable-wheeled devices that will offer mobility for those with a good sense of balance. Right now, half of the world's population lives in cities and the proliferation of large enclosed architectural enclaves will continue. The advent of powered exo-skeletal devices will allow mobility for the elderly and the heretofore mobility challenged. These will range from prosthetic limbs to full exo-frames activated by EKG waves linking the device directly to the brain. Organs will be 'grown' using one's own DNA print, a technique already on its way to accomplishment. Nano-engineered contact lens derivatives will 'float' information overlaid at will onto one's field of vision.

Illustrating the Future

As a designer I can illustrate my ideas. In my latest book, *Sentury II*, there are several examples of imaginative personal devices that combine the traditional functions of a PDA with cartridge-based aromas and stimulants making the product a cross-over between media functions and personal preference functions. Other illustrations that combine design with the ability to visualize and illustrate are a 'monster' gyro racing bike/vehicle, a luxury inter-galactic liner and future architecture as done for Qatar Steel's look at Doha. I designed a product for the movie *Mission Impossible III* called

the Mask Maker. It combined the ability to design a fictitious product with the conviction of a believable finished device.

The production of illustrative material will benefit from direct brain linkage to rapid prototype devices and the creation of scenario production by literally thinking about it. I can visualize the imagination favoured with unlimited resources of data and visual information.

There are, in my mind, caveats. With the brain now linked into a saturated visual and data rich world, when will one know the difference between 'real' and actual physical reality? Our dreams are the ultimate submersion into scenario with the complete range of sensory duplication we experience when we're awake. We'll certainly achieve that ability to duplicate reality to such an extent that it will be indistinguishable from, well, the touch and feel of the 'real' world.

Creating with Unlimited Information

If I could visualize in my mind marvelous scenarios and by triggering a learned response see my visions displayed on a



wall screen or on my nano-scaled lenses, I'd still be the judgemental monitor of result, picking and choosing iterations, shifting colour and altering scenic content. It would still be my individual motivation, sensibility, taste and sense of visual result. I could enlist endless access to pictorial reference and other data formats that would enrich my imaginative creation. Link this visualization ability to three-dimensional production and you'd have the incredible ability to literally create artifact by just visualizing the end result. You would watch your creation take form as a 3-D image, revolve the image, make adjustments based on design judgement and 'send' the data to a prototyping device or indeed anywhere in the world via global communication networks. The creative impetus would still be individual but vastly enhanced by technology now being proposed and experimented with. It's going to be a thrilling ride.

I'm fascinated by the promise of linkage to database, but on a need-to-know demand basis. I don't favor submersion into a constant deluge of sensation and information enabled by an implant. Our brains and vision field management parameters now sort through and present relevant sensory response as needed as we navigate our daily lives.

The world as we know it today will be strangely familiar but with a profound overlay of induced reality. The professional, social and governmental arenas will be forever altered and we'll be living in a download world that enables advantage not dreamed of today. As citizens of whatever society we are part of, our critically important responsibility is to blunt the role of restrictive government and reinforce individual access and beneficial utilization of techniques that will evolve. 



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